VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE TESLA DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on Tesla's cars, autonomy, robots, energy and stock

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 23, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF THU OCT 22 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

A special committee, in writing

"The Tesla board of directors has formed a special committee (the 'Special Committee') comprising disinterested directors to explore deepening Tesla's relationship with SpaceX, which could be through certain arrangements including without limitation a business combination," Tesla says in its third-quarter 10-Q, filed late Wednesday. "While there could be merits to a Transaction, there is no assurance that any such Transaction will be consummated," it adds; any deal would need the committee's recommendation and any required shareholder approval. SpaceX's own 10-Q, filed at 4:03 p.m. EDT Thursday, says its board has formed a committee too and that "no determination" has been made.

The shares fell 3.08% to $374.58 on Thursday after Tesla cut its 2026 capital spending forecast to about $20 billion from more than $25 billion, "raising concerns among investors counting on heavy investment for Elon Musk's AI and robotics vision," Reuters reported. "The risk is Tesla now enters a period of limbo while investors await news on a potential combination with SpaceX," AJ Bell's Russ Mould told the agency. At least nine brokers raised their price targets on Thursday, Yahoo Finance data show.

I · FULL SELF-DRIVING (FSD)

Robotaxi stretches to 1 a.m. in Austin

The service area now reaches the Formula 1 circuit ahead of race weekend, and later hours are coming.

"Tesla has just expanded its Robotaxi service area in Austin, Texas," Sawyer Merritt posted at 1:59 a.m. EDT Friday, adding that the new area "includes the area around Austin's F1 racetrack, where 400,000 people will attend the race festivities this weekend," and that the service "now runs until 1 AM (from 12 AM before)." Ten minutes later he added that service "could be blocked to the actual F1 event, although attendees should still be able to Robotaxi in the surrounding areas."



A Tesla Cybercab on Interstate 280 in California on September 19, 2026.
PHOTO: DANIEL LU (DLLU) / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY-SA 4.0 · CROPPED

On Wednesday's call, AI software head Ashok Elluswamy traced the hours: "we had initially had the Robotaxi service from 6:00 a.m. to 9:00 p.m., then we expanded to 10:00 p.m., 11:00 p.m. Now it's going to be pretty soon 2:00 a.m.," TeslaNorth reported. Asked whether regulators or software limit growth, he said: "It is technology-driven, but we do see that pretty quickly become regulatory, perhaps in Q1, Q2 timeframes."

Next on the map

Tesla's new Robotaxi safety report lists six operating cities, Austin, Dallas, Houston, Miami, Orlando and Tampa, and names Las Vegas, Jacksonville, Phoenix and San Antonio as coming next. It counts 862,000 miles driven after dark through October 18, out of 3.1 million autonomous miles in total, TeslaNorth noted.

II · SALES & DEMAND

No Cybertruck for Australia

Tesla cancelled reservations in Australia and New Zealand and raised U.S. Model Y loan rates.

"After careful consideration, plans to produce Cybertruck for Australia and New Zealand have been discontinued," Tesla Australia told reservation holders on Friday local time, Drive reported. "As a result, we're unable to fulfil your reservation and it will be cancelled. You'll receive a full refund for any payments made." Deposits were A$150, refundable, and had been taken since the truck's 2019 reveal.



A current-generation Tesla Model 3 in the Washington, DC, area, April 2025.
PHOTO: OWS PHOTOGRAPHY / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0

As a "thank you for your early support," holders who buy a new Model 3 or Model Y get one year of FSD (Supervised), valued at A$1,788, Drive said; the offer runs through the end of 2026, according to a post by Sawyer Merritt at 7:18 p.m. EDT Thursday. Just 20,237 Cybertrucks were sold in the U.S. last year, down from 38,965 in 2024, Drive said, citing Cox Automotive.

QUICK HIT

Costlier loans. Tesla raised U.S. financing rates on base and Premium Model Y trims to 2.49% APR from 1.99%, with the Performance trim unchanged at 3.99%, Sawyer Merritt posted at 12:19 a.m. EDT Friday.

III · ENERGY & CHARGING

Fort Bend says yes to "Project Crystal Sun"

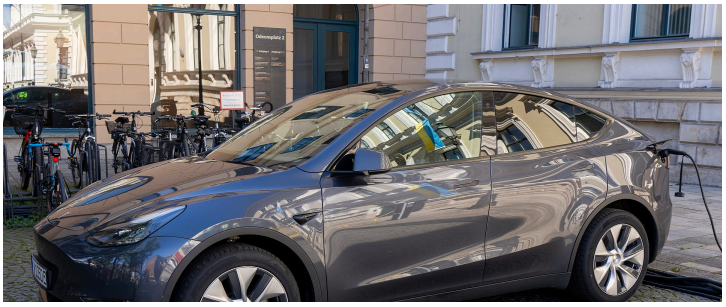
County commissioners approved incentives for a proposed $10.1 billion solar plant; the site is not final.

Fort Bend County commissioners approved a tax abatement, a grant agreement, foreign-trade-zone participation and a "True Up" payment-in-lieu-of-taxes agreement for Tesla's proposed solar cell manufacturing plant on Thursday, each in a 4–0 vote, with interim County Judge Daniel Wong abstaining "due to his company's work with Tesla," Community Impact reported. The $10.1 billion project would use part of a 3,057-acre site at FM 1994 and FM 762, create about 9,700 direct jobs and start operating in the first quarter of 2029 if the site is chosen; Tesla is weighing another location that has not been made public.

"This is a win for our residents and community partners," Commissioner Dexter McCoy said. A state school-tax limitation under the JETI Act awaits Gov. Greg Abbott's approval (Community Impact; KPRC).

Megapacks and Superchargers

"We are increasing production of Megapacks as much as possible," Musk replied at 2:13 p.m. EDT Thursday to a post quoting his call remark that Tesla is "almost sold out of all Megapacks for 2027." Tesla Charging announced a 16-stall Supercharger in Camp Verde, Arizona (post, 1:24 p.m. EDT).



A Tesla Model Y charges on Odeonsplatz in Munich, Germany, on September 4, 2023.
PHOTO: AUHAIDHAUSEN / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0

IV · THE SPACEX QUESTION

Two committees, no determination

Both companies' quarterly reports now describe the review of a possible combination.

Tesla's committee is made up of "disinterested directors," and a transaction "would be subject to, among other things, the affirmative recommendation of the Special Committee and, if agreed upon, any necessary shareholder approval," the 10-Q says. SpaceX's 10-Q says its board formed a committee "to evaluate a potential combination between SpaceX and Tesla,"

that "the board of directors of Tesla has also formed a special committee," and that any deal would need further approval from its committee, its board and "our controlling shareholder."



Building 1 at Tesla's Gigafactory Texas near Austin, the company's headquarters, shown on June 17, 2022.

PHOTO: LARRY D. MOORE / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0 · CROPPED

Reuters said a combination could create a company worth about $3.5 trillion. Capex is a delicate balance in this market, eToro's Josh Gilbert said. "For a stock priced on Cybercab and Optimus, that (capex forecast cut) explains why the shares went nowhere on a result that beat on most measures" (Reuters).

QUICK HIT

188 times earnings. Before Thursday's open, Tesla traded at 188.24 times forward earnings estimates, against 6.58 for Ford and 5.16 for General Motors, Reuters noted Thursday morning. At Thursday's close the shares were about 25% below their record intraday high of $498.83, set in December.

Tesla said in the 10-Q that in September it entered into three credit agreements with aggregate commitments of $30 billion; capital spending in the first nine months was $13.01 billion.

V · SEC FILINGS

No new Tesla filings since Thursday morning

None since Oct 22, 8:00 a.m. EDT — EDGAR shows no new Tesla filings through Friday morning.

10-Q · Oct 21, 8:12 p.m. EDT — Quarterly report for the period ended Sep 30; discloses the special committee on SpaceX; 3,952,757,946 shares outstanding as of Oct 15. Filing

8-K · Oct 21, 4:41 p.m. EDT — Third-quarter results, with the shareholder update as Exhibit 99.1. Filing

Related · SpaceX 10-Q · Oct 22, 4:03 p.m. EDT — Space Exploration Technologies Corp. discloses its own board committee to evaluate "a potential combination between SpaceX and Tesla." Filing

Related · SpaceX S-8 · Oct 22, 4:24 p.m. EDT — Registers about 71.1 million Class A shares for options and restricted stock units assumed in the Aug. 14 acquisition of Cursor maker Anysphere, plus 23.6 million shares for resale. Filing

Insider trades, last 120 days (Form 4) — Sep 8: Chief Financial Officer Vaibhav Taneja sold 2,605.75 shares at $360.13 after 6,539 restricted stock units vested on Sep 5; 25,972.25 shares afterward (filed Sep 9).

Takeaways

1. Tesla's 10-Q confirms a board committee exploring a SpaceX combination.
2. TSLA fell 3.08% as the capital spending cut raised doubts.
3. Austin Robotaxi now runs until 1 a.m. and reaches the F1 circuit area.
4. Cybertruck is cancelled for Australia and New Zealand.
5. Fort Bend County approved incentives for a $10.1 billion solar plant.

SOURCES

Posts by @elonmusk, @SawyerMerritt and @TeslaCharging on X; SEC EDGAR; Tesla and SpaceX 10-Qs; Tesla Robotaxi safety report; Reuters (via Investing.com); TeslaNorth; Drive; Community Impact; KPRC Click2Houston; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: Wikimedia Commons (Daniel Lu, CC BY-SA 4.0; OWS Photography, CC BY 4.0; AuHaidhausen, CC BY 4.0; Larry D. Moore, CC BY 4.0).

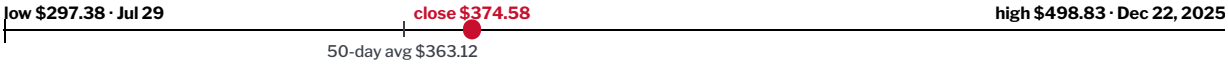
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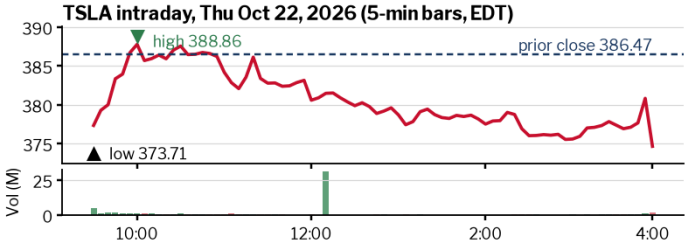
Down 3.1% the day after the report

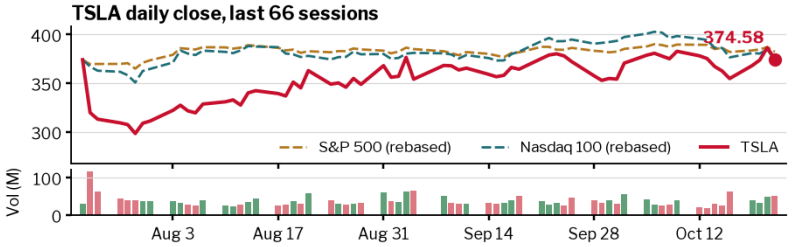
Brokers raised targets anyway: BNP Paribas lifted its rating to Neutral with a $420 target, and Piper Sandler went to $475.

CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$374.58	−$11.89	$374.29	$388.86	$373.71
Thu Oct 22, 4:00 p.m. EDT	*−3.08% vs $386.47*	*regular session*	*10:00 a.m. EDT bar*	*9:30 a.m. EDT bar*
VOLUME	**52-WEEK RANGE**	**MARKET CAP**	**5-DAY / 1-MONTH**	**YEAR TO DATE**
51.48M	$297–$499	$1.48T	+3.4% / −1.5%	−16.71%
+46.4% vs 30-session avg 35.16M	*$297.38 (Jul 29, 2026) to $498.83 (Dec 22, 2025)*	*3.95B shares (10-Q cover, Oct 15) × close*	*5 and 21 sessions*	*vs Dec 31, 2025 close*

52-WEEK RANGE







As of close Oct 22, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 22 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	YTD
TSLA	**−3.08%**	**+3.35%**	**−1.46%**	**−16.71%**
S&P 500	−1.21%	−1.04%	−0.55%	+11.95%
Nasdaq 100	−2.90%	−3.26%	−4.96%	+14.69%
RIVN	−3.21%	−7.37%	−19.71%	−38.81%
GM	+1.45%	−7.71%	−7.83%	−5.05%
F	+0.34%	−3.01%	−7.73%	−8.99%

OPTIONS (CBOE, THU OCT 22 CLOSE)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 23	277,223	282,661	1.02	54.2%	$400 / $130
Oct 26	68,898	36,475	0.53	39.9%	$455 / $310
Oct 28	14,795	16,246	1.10	43.0%	$400 / $350
Oct 30	107,499	113,118	1.05	43.4%	$400 / $300
All expiries	**3,168,904**	**2,493,730**	**0.79**		**30-day IV index 39.8**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 23

Strong buy	4
Buy	14
Hold	23
Sell	2
Strong sell	0
Mean rating (1 = strong buy)	2.35
Mean target (38 analysts)	$408.36 (+9.0%)
Median target	$427.50
High / low target	$600.00 / $128.11

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	70.93M
Change vs. mid-September	−4.4%
Short % of float	2.01%
Days to cover	1.79
Held by insiders	17.81%
Held by institutions	43.69%
BlackRock, Jun 30	5.42%
Vanguard, Jun 30	4.66%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 22 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS $0.91)	411.6
Forward P/E (est. $2.19)	171.1
Price/sales (rev. $103.6B)	14.3
Beta (5-year monthly)	1.92
50-day average	$363.12 (+3.2%)
200-day average	$386.64 (−3.1%)
2026 capex plan (Reuters)	~$20B
Prior guidance	>$25B

RATING ACTIONS, THURSDAY OCT 22

FIRM	RATING	TARGET
BNP Paribas	Up to Neutral	$266 to $420
CLSA	Up to Hold	$310 to $400
Piper Sandler	Overweight	$450 to $475
Canaccord	Buy	$410 to $442
JPMorgan	Neutral	$415 to $430
UBS	Neutral	$391 to $425
Morgan Stanley	Equal-Weight	$400 to $410

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Fri Oct 23	Weekly options expiry (largest near-term OI)
Fri Oct 30	Cybercab answers due to NHTSA
Sat Nov 7	In-person meeting drawing closes, 12:59 a.m. EST
Wed Dec 2	Proxy voting deadline, 11:59 p.m. EST
Thu Dec 3	**Annual meeting, 4:00 p.m. EST**

Prices and averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 22). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest, ownership and forward EPS: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Fri Oct 23, 8:41 a.m. EDT. Trailing P/E (price to earnings per share, EPS) uses GAAP EPS for the last four quarters from Tesla's shareholder update; price/sales uses trailing revenue at the Oct 22 close. Shares: Tesla 10-Q cover page, Oct 15. Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) is contracts outstanding after Wednesday's close, P/C is the put/call ratio by OI, ATM IV is implied volatility at the $375 strike at Thursday's close. Calendar: DEF 14A, VoteTesla.com.